

2026 Leadership of The United Church

Official Board

Mary Beth Fortunato (U)
Jim Boseck (U)
Dale Zajac (P)
Lydia Busch (U)
Brian Wiser (U)
Sonya Brooks* (P)
Amelia Cunningham (Youth)

Jen Eveleigh (B)
Kevin Wall (U)
Bob Cunningham (B)
Wendy Bacon (U)
Andrew Duncan (B)
Steve Simpson (U)
Anna Zajac (Youth)

Board of Trustees

Dean Williamson (U)
Connie Frye (U)
Steve Smythe (P)
John Eveleigh (P)
Jeannie Blance (P)
Bill Clark (P)

Lynn Bernard* (B)
Wes Posson (U)
Jim Abdallah (U)
Mary Wiser (U)
Joy Van Riper (B)

Board of Stewards

Marion Sumpter*
Bev Fehrenbach
Bill Fortunato*
Gail Benjamin
Nancy Gerstner
Becky Boseck

Dan Frye
Randy Bacon
Melissa Wormer
Leslie Roof
Sharyn Canham*
Margie Wall

Endowment Trustees

Mark Sheppard
Tom Wormer
Chuck Lowell

Ric Parsons
David Russell
Levi Allen

Church Staff

Office Hours: Monday - Friday, 9:00am to 1:00 pm 585-394-0503

Pastor:	Wade Allen	pastor@uccdga.org
Pastor of Youth & Adult Ministries:	Mark Slomski	mark.slomski@uccdga.org
Director of Family Ministries:	Deb Marshall	deb.marshall@uccdga.org
Director of Care Ministries:	Christy Allen	christy.allen@uccdga.org
Office Manager & Financial Sec.:	Carolyn Russell	office@uccdga.org
Treasurer:	Nancy Lamberson	nancy.lamberson@uccdga.org
Choir Director:	Georgia Sperano	gsperano@rochester.rr.com
Organist:	David Kraft	

WELCOME TO THE UNITED CHURCH

Weekly Bulletin

Sunday
OCTOBER 11, 2026



THE
UNITED
CHURCH
CANANDAIGUA



Order of Worship for
OCTOBER 11, 2026



Welcome! The United Church is a Presbyterian/American Baptist congregation. We hope you enjoy your visit and let us know if we can help you in any way.

PRELUDE: “Before Your throne I now appear” by Johann Sebastian Bach

WELCOME AND GREETING TO OUR ONLINE CONGREGATION

OUR PREPARATION

Focus of the Day: God looks upon our sin with tender mercy; he always chases us with grace and offers us a new beginning. He defends us from Satan’s lies that would lead us to believe we are anything but chosen and deeply loved.

INTROIT: (11:00) “Open Our Eyes, Lord” (Hymn #536)

United Church Choir

CALL TO WORSHIP (from Psalm 103)

Leader: Praise the Lord, O my soul!

People: With all my inmost being, praise his holy name.

Leader: The Lord is compassionate and gracious, slow to anger, abounding in love.

People: He does not treat us as our sins deserve or repay us according to our iniquities.

Leader: As a father has compassion on his children, so the Lord has compassion on those who fear him.

All: From everlasting to everlasting the Lord’s love is with those who fear him. Praise the Lord, O my soul!

***HYMN #30: “I Will Sing of the Mercies”**

CCLI Song #1767224, words: ©1986 CRC Publications/Faith Alive Christian Resources; Music: Public Domain, CCLI Lic. #11593017

***OPENING PRAYER:** Abba Father we confess that we have not loved you with our whole heart, nor have we loved our neighbor as we love ourselves. In your compassionate kindness, would you forgive us Lord? Grant us a new beginning today as we come before your throne of grace. Show us more of who you are so that our hearts might be transformed into your likeness. Heal our hearts as we pray together the words of our Lord ... Our Father who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name. Thy Kingdom come, thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors. And lead us not into temptation but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, forever. Amen.

***WORDS OF ASSURANCE**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;
As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be,
world without end. Amen, Amen.

***GLORIA PATRI: #807**

GOD SPEAKS TO US THROUGH THE WORD

FIRST SCRIPTURE READING: Psalm 51:7-12 (page 562) {A.B. page 637}

SPECIAL MUSIC: (8:45) “I’d Rather Have Jesus” by G.B. Shea, arr J. Hudson

Joy VanRiper (piano)

ANTHEM: (11:00) “Amazing Grace” arr. Russell Robinson (words on insert)

United Church Choir

CHILDREN’S MESSAGE: (11:00) Deb Marshall

SECOND SCRIPTURE READING: Ephesians 4:20-5:2 (page 1158) {A.B. page 1298}

Sermon

“A New Beginning”
(Zechariah 3)
Rev. Lauren Blanco

OUR RESPONSE IN FAITH

***HYMN #472: “Grace Greater than Our Sin”**

CCLI Song #31690, Public Domain, Inc., CCLI Lic. #11593017

CONGREGATIONAL PRAYER

OFFERTORY: Pastorale-Improvisation on “Fillmore”

***DOXOLOGY: #809**

Praise God from whom all blessings flow;
Praise him all creatures here below;
Praise him above, ye heavenly host:
Praise Father, Son, and Holy Ghost. Amen.

***HYMN (Lyrics on insert): “Amazing Grace, My Chains are Gone”**

CCLI Song #4768151, ©2006 Rising Springs Music, CCLI Lic. #11593017

BENEDICTION

POSTLUDE: “Con moto maestoso” from Sonata No. 3 by Felix Mendelssohn

** indicates an invitation to stand for those who are able and comfortable doing so.*

PRAYER SUPPORT IN THE NARTHEX: (11:00) Trained Care Ministers are available following the service to pray for anyone desiring prayer

Scriptures for next week, October 18

Sermon Scripture: **Zechariah 4-6**

First Reading: **Psalms 104:27-30**

Second Reading: **Philippians 1:3-6**

PRAYER REQUESTS

Health concerns: Ray Demont (Jeannie Blance's brother-in-law), Marion Sumpter, Beth Smythe, Claire Sheppard and family, Linda Gilbert and Braeden Flynn, Daniel Zimmerman (nephew of Wendy Bacon), Cheryl Casey, Jenifer Parks (friend of Natalie DeTraglia), Bill Kenyon, Deanna Stocker and Everest Ferrante (Ardelle Bigos relatives), Martha Ashley, Sherry Wesley (cousin of Sue V and Sandi D), Scott Smail (friend of Kathleen Boniak), Sheila Henderson, Phil Greene (Sharon Meyer's brother), Rodney Newfrock (friend of Elaine Allen), Jessica Canham (Sharyn's daughter), Tom Babcock (friend of Jenny Caron), Catherine Kurzdorfer (Adam Thorman's mother), Marcus (friend of Sandi DiCicco), Denise Loy (friend of Kory Massey), Steve Sedlock (Nancy Tharp's brother), Clancy Cragle (Michelle's grandfather)

Cancer: Sumer Miller, Bruce G (brother-in-law of Kathi Nacca), Scott Kesel (friend of Sandi D), David Landon (friend of Sue V and Sandi D), Michael M. (friend of Kathi Nacca), Steve J. (Claire Sheppard's brother), Robbie Bass (Linda Bailey's nephew), Daniel Cage (friend of Wade Allen), Karen Linder (niece of Joyce Laursen), Sue Whybra and Rod Gifford (cousins of Joyce Laursen), Kathy Cool (daughter-in-law of the Pecks), Sophie Snyder (friend of Amelia Cunningham), Chris Alexander (Carolyn Russell's brother), Sarah Hough (daughter of Dianne Beaumont), Laura Fiorito (daughter of Charles and Patti Cagwin), Douglas Cook (Jen Eveleigh's brother), Keith Laursen (Joyce's brother-in-law), Sasha (friend of Megan French), John Tornow (friend of Elaine Allen), Susan Hennessy (Jen Eveleigh's sister), Deb Dawson (Steve Smythe's niece), Jim Davis (Scott's father), Stephen Carges (Paula Traber's brother)

Military Service: Tech SGT Nicholas DelVillano (Frye's son-in-law) USAF stationed in Germany, JJ Callard (USN), US Army CPT Andrew Marlin (Tyler Bosecks husband) home from deployment, LTJG Nick Castiller (USN), MAC Adam Thorman (USN), E6 Cody Wells (USN) home from deployment, TSgt Timothy Peck (USAF)

Missionaries: Carlos Bonilla & Mayra Giovantti – the BGs (Central/South America), Christy Lafferty (Nicaragua), Leodegario Hernandez & Maria Angela Bautista (Bacalar, Mexico pastoral couple), Rev. Nancy and Rev. Shelvis Smith-Mather (South Sudan), Sally Gates (UK), Matt and Meredith Snell (Fort Drum, NY).

Highlights for This Week

- **The Office will be closed tomorrow, October 12 for the holiday.**
- **Please join us this morning in the dining room following the 8:45 service for a special Intergenerational Sunday School class on Missions!** Find out about the 1st missionary! Muffins and coffee available! :-)
- **2027 NC Mission Trip Info Meeting - TODAY**, 12:00pm (after service) - Join us after service to review our 2027 trip and service opportunities in North Carolina! Proposed trip dates are 3/20/2027-3/25/2027. Cannot make it? Contact Mark S. or Sonya B. for a separate connect.
- **Adult Retreat at Onanda Park - Saturday**, October 24, 9:30am-12:30pm - Join us for worship (by Mike O'Brien), lunch, and Pastor Wally Fleming for our next retreat! Bring your own Bible, pen/journal, and anything you need while at a park (Crouch Hall). A free-will donation (\$20 suggested) will be collected at the door during sign-in. A physical sign-up sheet is in the Welcome Center, or you can register online. *Can you help? We need all sorts of support, including worship planning, sign in, set up/tear down, food shopping/serving, etc.*
- **Student-Led Community Prayer Event - Saturday**, October 24, 3pm-5pm - Join Pastor Mark and youth (representing several churches in the Canandaigua area, including ours!) at the Canandaigua KOA Campground for prayer, fellowship and fun activities! The theme is "rooted in prayer" and is the first event planned by Christian students in the area.
- **Our Greeter/Coordinator for October: Dan F.** Please contact Dan or the office if you need help signing up.

Are You Visiting Us Today?

If so, WELCOME to the United Church, we are so glad that you have chosen to worship with us. We invite you to pick up a tan bag (with the United Church logo on it) for yourself/your family to take home and to learn a little bit more about us. **We are so happy that you joined us today and look forward to seeing you again soon!**



Families & Children

Do you have little ones with you? **We're glad you're here!** We offer several options to help families worship comfortably together.



Nursery care is available during the service. **Children (infants through 5-years-old) are welcome in the nursery at any time during the service.** All nursery volunteers are background checked. The infant nursery, which is located adjacent to the preschool nursery, is also open and available for parents to use during the service for diaper changes, nursing, etc.

Children's Time is offered after the Children's Sermon on most Sundays for **children in Kindergarten through 2nd grade.**

Learning to Worship/Understanding Your Faith is offered after the Children's Sermon every Sunday through Nov 1 **for children in 3rd through 5th grade.**

The narthex (the area through the back doors of the sanctuary) is also **available throughout the service for children and a caregiver.** This space allows you to continue seeing and hearing the service while giving your child the freedom to move around or make a little noise.

For children who remain in the service, the worship activity cart will be available in the narthex every Sunday.

Please be sure to return reusable items.



We invite each family to choose the worship option that works best for them. *At the same time, we kindly ask that if a child becomes disruptive during the service, they be taken from the sanctuary until they are settled.* Thank you for helping us create a welcoming worship environment for all.



World Mission Offering

Today, and next Sunday, we are receiving our annual World Mission Offering. One half of this special offering is used by the American Baptist International Missions to support international missionaries and projects in over 70 countries. One half of our giving will be used by the Presbyterian Disaster Assistance program to aid communities affected by disasters. Envelopes were included in your October Lamplighter or simply mark your gift for the World Mission Offering. The fund is also available through our online giving. Thank you!



Family Promise Gift Cards

Family Promise of Ontario County (FPOC) helps families facing or experiencing **homelessness** by providing them a stable place to live, work and financial education, and other support needed to get on their feet. The new FPOC static site on N. Main St is open and active!!! This will have such a positive impact for families living on the edge. God knows and cares! And so do we!



During **October**, our church family would like to help FPOC by **donating \$25, \$50, or \$100 grocery and/or fuel gift cards, or by writing a check to Family Promise.**

Families purchase their own groceries, make their own meals, and fuel their own cars, if they have them. Please

consider chipping in! Gift cards may be placed in the offering plate or left with Carolyn during office hours. Questions? Please see Cathy or Mary Lou. Please add your prayers to this and Thank You for your consideration!

- The Mission Collection Team

Beaver Camp Fundraising Dinner

November 7, 2026 @ 5:30 pm in The United Church Dining Room

An opportunity to support and learn about the place that has changed the lives and faith of many in our congregation.

Tickets are complimentary, and we graciously ask guests to make a donation to help support the event and its mission. Your generosity is appreciated. See Bob or Brenda Cunningham for tickets.



Missions Let the light of Christ shine through you in service to others...

Mission Grocery Donations

With rising food costs, more families are turning to food pantries to help put food on the table. Some are going into credit card debt with grocery expenses. CCIA is experiencing a large jump in the number of 1st time families. Your food donations here will help supply the Salvation Army and CCIA (Canandaigua Churches in Action) Food Pantries. CCIA needs staples such as **spaghetti sauce, canned fruit and vegetables, tuna, and cereal** (which is not always available through FoodLink). Donations can be placed in the Mission Center. Thank you for sharing out of what God has given you!



North Carolina Mission Trip 2027



There will be an informational meeting for the 2027 Inter-generational Mission Trip. The trip is planned for **March 20 – 26** and we will be returning to Black Mountain, NC. We will be working with the **Valley Hope Foundation (valleyhopefoundation.org)** once again as well as starting a relationship with **Black Mountain Home for children (BMH) (blackmountainhome.org)**. BMH is an organization that works with children displaced from their families. Please join us **TODAY at 12:00 in the Fellowship room** for more information and if you are thinking about joining the team. Contact Sonya B. (sonya.brooks99@yahoo.com) with any questions.



Fall Fellowship & Fun
Saturday, October 17, from 11:00 a.m. to 1:00 p.m.
Hosted by our Stewards for all our friends ages 85 and older

Join us for a special fall gathering beginning with worship and Communion led by Pastor Wade. Afterward, the Stewards will serve lunch, followed by a sing-along of favorite oldies with Dan on guitar, Becky on piano, and Sharyn singing. We'll also enjoy lighthearted activities and plenty of time to visit with friends.

To RSVP, contact Christy at 765-717-5229 or christy.allen@uccdga.org

We look forward to sharing this wonderful fall day with you!



Youth Club Mission Project

Christmas Stockings for NYC. We are preparing for the Youth Club stocking project. These stockings are given to children along with a presentation of the Gospel message. **Donated items must be new, small and able to fit into a 5"x9" stocking.** Stocking stuffer ideas: toy cars, yo-yos, small games, bouncy balls, gum, socks, hard candy, hair accessories, jump ropes, coin purses, jewelry, trading cards, pencils/pencil sharpeners, gloves, hats, small stuffed animals or dolls, etc! **Note:** Coloring books and most small puzzles are too large for these stockings. Please no toy weapons or violent action figures. Please bring your donations to Deb's office. Items need to be donated **by November 1.** Thank you!!



Thank you and keep in touch!

Marion Sumpter wanted to thank everyone for the lovely send-off last week. She said it was a special blessing and she was humbled by the kindness and prayers she received. She just couldn't believe how many people lined up to give her hugs. She wanted to share her new address, so you can keep in touch.

Marion Sumpter
24 Allen Ave.
Wyoming, OH 45215



Financial Report through September 30th.

During the first nine months of the year, donations and pledges received were \$18,617.29 less than budgeted and \$4,993.29 less than the same period in 2025. Total net loss for this period was \$28,725.25. Our budget for 2026 predicted that we would have a deficit of \$23,621.31, so we have lost an additional \$5,103.94 so far.

We have had two months so far this year where we have not even been able to cover all of the costs for the staff let alone any other expenses that we incur on a regular basis. The staff are doing all that they can to cut back on costs. Ultimately, our financial problems are not due to spending more than expected; they are due to a large decrease in pledges and donations that we were unable to predict. **Please prayerfully consider contributing more to help keep our programs going.**

We will begin the budgeting process for 2027 very soon and anticipate having less money to allocate to programs. For this reason, **we are not inviting budget requests for 2027.** At some point this fall, we will contact each program/team/committee and let you know how much we anticipate being able to allocate to you. All groups will be receiving less than they have in the past.

The Finance Committee will hold two informational meetings with regards to the finances on Sunday Oct 18th, one after each service. These are not formal congregational meetings – no votes will be taken.

Stewardship Kickoff

We're off to a great start! Last week began the **pledge season for the 2027 year.** We have already had **21** returned, with **\$91,843** pledged to Operating and **\$17,912** pledged to Missions.

Letters and forms were mailed out but if you have not received them, there are extra pledge form packets in the Welcome Center. Feel free to place them in the offering plate, mail them in, or put them in the box marked "Pledges". Please remember that at the United Church, we have separate pledges for the Operating Budget and the Missions Budget. You decide how your donations are split. Any forms that don't designate how to split the pledge, or say something like "wherever it's needed most", by default go 100% to Operating. So if you would like to support our missions as well, please let us know on your form!

It would be helpful to return pledge forms **by November 1st** if possible, to assist our Trustees in preparing a budget for approval. Watch the future bulletin announcements and the office door to track our progress!

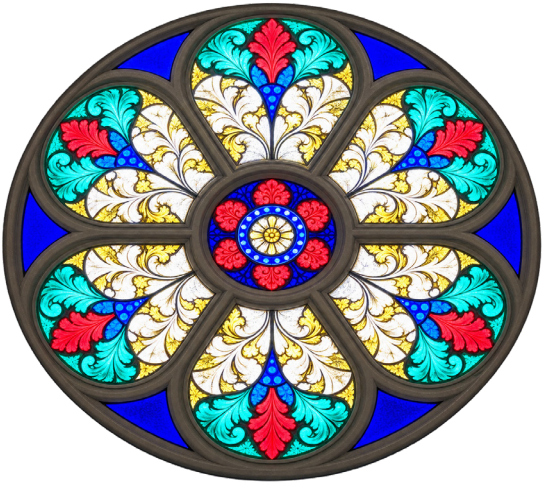


Amazing Grace (11:00 service) Anthem arr Russell Robinson

Oo. Amazing grace, how sweet the sound,
That saved a wretch like me!
I once was lost, but now am found,
Was blind but now I see.

Through many dangers, toils, and snares,
I have already come;
'Tis grace hath brought me safe thus far,
And grace will lead me home.

Oo, ah. When we've been there ten thousand years,
Bright shining as the sun, we've no less days to sing
God's praise, than when we first begun.
We've no less days to sing God's praise,
Than when we first begun.



Amazing Grace, My Chains are Gone (3rd Hymn)

Verse 1

Amazing grace how sweet the sound
That saved a wretch like me
I once was lost but now I'm found
Was blind but now I see

Verse 2

'Twas grace that taught my heart to fear
And grace my fears relieved
How precious did that grace appear
The hour I first believed

Chorus

My chains are gone I've been set free
My God my Savior has ransomed me
And like a flood His mercy rains
Unending love amazing grace

Verse 3

The Lord has promised good to me
His word my hope secures
He will my shield and portion be
As long as life endures

Verse 4

The earth shall soon dissolve like snow
The sun forbear to shine
But God who called me here below
Will be forever mine
Will be forever mine
You are forever mine